John Victor Aniekwe

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8 November 2026
Hiring Team, AI Fellows Program – Africa Regional Offices
Gates Foundation
Re: AI Fellow – Africa Regional Offices (Requisition B021830), Abuja

Dear Hiring Team,

I am applying for the AI Fellow – Africa Regional Offices role, based in Abuja. I am a Nigerian citizen and can work in Nigeria without sponsorship.

Since December 2025, I have worked at GVOC deploying Azure OpenAI, Azure AI Foundry and Databricks workloads on Kubernetes for an AI prediction platform that achieves more than 60% prediction accuracy. My work covers the model and data services and the pipelines, security controls and monitoring that keep them dependable. Your sample projects need that foundation: a decision-support tool helps a ministry or district team only if it stays reliable, secure and easy to maintain after the prototype stage.

Before GVOC, I spent four years as an L3 Azure engineer at TeKnowledge. I sustained a 99.9% uptime SLA, resolved 99% of escalations on the first day, and brought Microsoft Copilot into our incident workflow with our troubleshooting guides and wikis as its knowledge source. That taught me an early lesson about AI adoption: people act on AI answers when the answers are grounded in information they already trust.

I also know the institutions these tools serve. As System Administrator at the Akwa Ibom State Ministry of Finance, Budget & National Planning, I supported the systems behind budgeting and financial planning, and at Access Bank I worked on infrastructure where downtime has a direct cost. Tools that trace priorities through procurement and cash release, or flag stock-out risk before medicines expire, depend on that institutional context as much as on the models.

I hold the KCNA and three AWS certifications and am completing the Cisco CyberOps Associate, which is sharpening how I protect sensitive health and financial data. I would welcome the chance to bring this mix of production engineering and Nigerian public-sector experience to the first Africa-based cohort.

Thank you for your consideration.

Sincerely,
John Victor Aniekwe